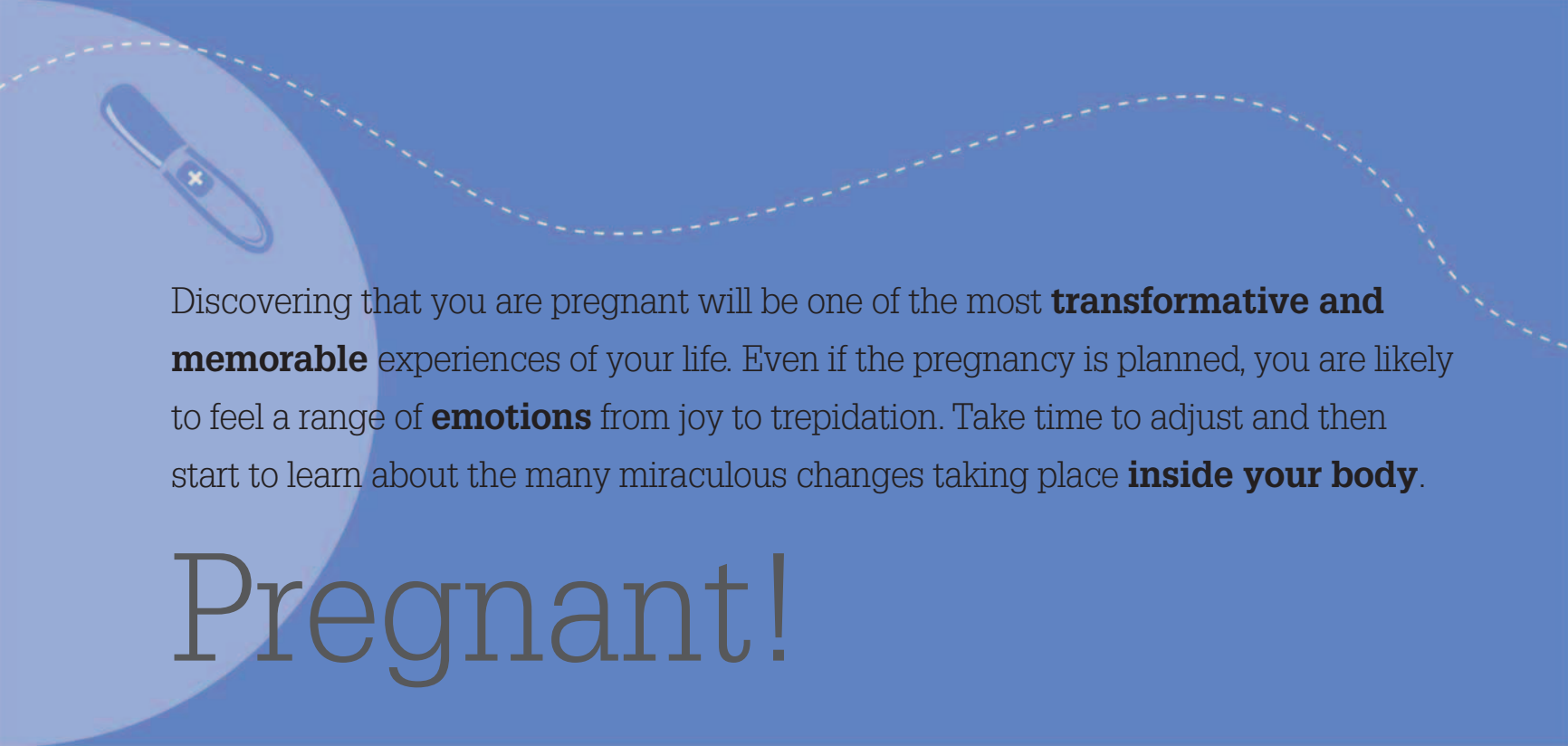




Discovering that you are pregnant will be one of the most **transformative and memorable** experiences of your life. Even if the pregnancy is planned, you are likely to feel a range of **emotions** from joy to trepidation. Take time to adjust and then start to learn about the many miraculous changes taking place **inside your body**.

Pregnant!

Finding out that you are pregnant

Congratulations! You are now on an amazing, life-changing journey. Perhaps you have missed your period, or noticed symptoms such as sore breasts, nausea, and extreme fatigue. Maybe you know just how far along you must be, or it has taken weeks to realize you could be pregnant. Whether you have been actively trying to get pregnant, have been undergoing fertility treatment, or your pregnancy was unplanned, enjoy the moment of discovery—there is no more exciting and momentous news.

Most women find out they are pregnant by doing a home pregnancy test since these are so accurate and reliable. In some circumstances, a blood test or ultrasound may be needed to confirm a pregnancy.

One or both of you may feel overwhelmed that you are going to be parents. It is quite normal to have a number of questions and concerns—about your stage of pregnancy and when your baby is due, and whether your baby is healthy. You may look to the future and wonder about how much life will change, but try not to get too anxious—you have plenty of time until your baby is born.

If you are a single parent, whether you have an unexpected or a planned pregnancy, you may be experiencing some anxiety, as well as shock or delight.

There is no right or wrong time to tell people that you are having a baby. You may want to confide only in immediate family members until you are into your second trimester and the likelihood of miscarriage is minimal. Otherwise, trust your instincts and tell those close friends and family members whom you know will actively support you through the first weeks of pregnancy.

If you work, you may want to wait until you have had your first ultrasound before you tell your boss. However, if you are experiencing symptoms such as nausea and vomiting it can be more difficult to hide your pregnancy. Also, if your job involves chemicals or heavy lifting then you will definitely need to tell your manager.

What to expect

It is worth familiarizing yourself with the common symptoms of early pregnancy, such as fatigue and nausea, and finding ways to cope with them. Equally, be reassured that you may not have any symptoms and this is normal for some women.

Many of the more difficult symptoms, such as vomiting and fatigue lessen by early in the second trimester and you may find at that time you begin to relax and enjoy your pregnancy a bit more.